

Global AI Usage Report

How Many People Are Using Artificial Intelligence?

March 2026 · Comprehensive Global Analysis

This report synthesizes the latest data from DataReportal, Microsoft AI Economy Institute, McKinsey, Stanford HAI, Grand View Research, DemandSage, and dozens of additional primary sources to provide a comprehensive picture of artificial intelligence adoption worldwide.

1. Global AI User Base

As of early 2026, artificial intelligence has crossed a historic milestone: over **1.35–1.5 billion people** actively use AI tools each month — roughly **16.3 % of the world's population** and approximately one in five internet users. Despite this rapid ascent, around 5 billion internet users have yet to adopt AI, underscoring that the technology remains in the early stages of mass diffusion.

1.4 B+ Monthly Active AI Users Globally	16.3 % Share of World Population	5 B+ Internet Users Not Yet Using AI
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For context, social-media platforms took more than a decade to achieve comparable user numbers. Standalone AI tools — led by ChatGPT — reached this threshold in roughly **three years**, a rate of adoption unprecedented in the history of consumer technology.

2. AI Adoption by Region & Country

Adoption rates vary enormously across geographies. Emerging-market nations — particularly in South and South-East Asia and the Middle East — are adopting AI faster than more mature economies, driven by mobile-first internet access and younger demographic profiles.

Top Countries by AI Adoption Rate (Working-Age Population)

Country / Region	Adoption Rate	Notable Context
India	~73 %	Fastest absolute growth; 4× wealthier nations' pace
UAE	64.0 %	Highest adoption in the Middle East
Singapore	60.9 %	Asia-Pacific leader
Chile	~60 %	Latin America leader
South Korea	~30 %	+80 % YoY — fastest growth rate globally
EU Average	32.7 %	Individuals aged 16–74

USA	28.3 %	77.2 M monthly ChatGPT users
UK	~29 %	Strong enterprise uptake
China	~83 %*	*Awareness metric; ChatGPT blocked — 250 M domestic users

Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026; Microsoft AI Economy Institute; AllAboutAI Global Adoption Index.

Regional Market Share

Region	2025 Market Share	Growth (CAGR)	Outlook
North America	36.9 %	~17 %	Dominant today; incremental gains
Asia-Pacific	33.0 %	19.8 %	Expected to dominate by 2030 (~47 %)
Europe	~18 %	~16 %	Regulatory environment shaping pace
Rest of World	~12 %	~21 %	Fastest-growing but smallest base

Note: Global North adoption rate 24.7 %; Global South 14.1 % — gap widening.

3. Leading AI Platforms & User Counts

ChatGPT — launched in November 2022 — remains by far the most-used AI platform, accounting for roughly 80 % of the AI chatbot market. However, competition from Google, Microsoft, Anthropic, and a wave of domestic Asian models is intensifying.

Platform	Monthly Active Users	Key Metric	Market Share
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	~1 B MAU / 900 M WAU	5.72 B web visits/mo; 2.5 B prompts/day	~80.5 %
Google Gemini	400–750 M MAU	Integrated in Google Search (2 B+ users)	~21.5 % (global)
Microsoft Copilot	~101 M users	85 % of Fortune 500 firms	~12.6 % (AI search)
Anthropic Claude	~30 M MAU	25 B API calls/month	~4.7 %
Perplexity AI	30–40 M MAU	30 M daily queries	~6.2 % (US)
DeepSeek	n/a	Domestic China focus	~3.7 %
Grok (xAI)	n/a	X / Twitter integration	~3.4 %

Sources: DemandSage ChatGPT Statistics 2026; First Page Sage Chatbot Market Share Mar 2026; SEOProfy Perplexity Statistics.

Enterprise Reach

- **92 %** of Fortune 500 companies use ChatGPT in some capacity.
- OpenAI holds **7 M+ workplace seats** and **1 M+ business customers**.
- OpenAI's annualised revenue: **\$10 B** (June 2025); valuation: **\$730 B**.
- **78 %** of organisations reported using AI in 2024–25, up from 55 % the prior year (McKinsey State of AI 2025).

4. AI Adoption by Industry

Sector	Adoption Rate	Key Highlights
IT / Telecom	83–85 %	48 % deploying agentic AI (highest); \$4.7 T gross value by 2035
Manufacturing	77 %	23 % avg reduction in downtime; 98 % expect efficiency gains
Education	~86 %*	*Student usage; 92 % use AI for assessments (up from 53 % in 2024)
Healthcare	40 %	CAGR 36.83 %; market \$868 B by 2030; 223 FDA-approved AI devices (2023)
Financial Services	~68 %	\$20 B+ annual AI spending; robo-advisors manage \$1.2 T in assets
Retail / CPG	~47 %	47 % deploying agentic AI; GenAI highest ROI in marketing & sales

Sources: McKinsey State of AI 2025; Mezzi AI Adoption Rates by Industry; NVIDIA State of AI 2026.

71 % of organisations regularly use generative AI in at least one business function, and **86 %** of companies plan to increase their AI budgets — with **40 %** targeting increases of 10 % or more.

5. Market Size & Growth Projections

\$244 B Global AI Market 2025	\$800 B+ Projected Market 2030	\$19.9 T Cumulative GenAI Economic Impact by 2030
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Metric	2025	2026	2029–2030	CAGR
Global AI Market	\$244 B	\$312 B	\$800 B+	~27 %
Gartner AI Spend	\$1.5 T	\$2.0 T	\$3.3 T	~22 %
Generative AI Market	\$22–64 B	—	\$220–325 B	29–41 %
AI User Base	1.35 B	—	—	~40 %+
AI Platforms Market	—	Growing	+\$101 B	40.5 %

Sources: Grand View Research; Gartner; Master of Code GenAI Statistics.

Workforce Impact

- AI projected to **create 170 M new jobs** while displacing 92 M by 2030 (net positive of 78 M).
- LinkedIn reports a **13× increase** in AI-related job postings over 5 years; talent supply only grew 8×.
- Workers using generative AI save an average of **5.4 % of their work hours** per week.
- Agentic AI expected to resolve **80 % of customer-service issues** autonomously by 2029.

6. Demographics of AI Users

Age Distribution

Age Group	Weekly AI Usage	Notes
Gen Z (18–25)	~70 %	Highest adoption; under-25s = 42 % of ChatGPT's user base
Millennials (26–41)	56 %	Deloitte; 29.7 % of ChatGPT users are aged 25–34
Adults 18–29	46 %	Pew Research
Adults 30–49	~35 %	Moderate usage; workplace-driven
Adults 50–64	~28 %	Growing; productivity focus
Adults 65+	23 %	Lowest adoption; awareness gap key barrier

Sources: TheySaid How Generations Use AI 2026; National University AI Statistics.

Gender Gap

A notable gender divide persists in AI adoption:

- **44 %** of men vs. **33 %** of women report using AI (2024 figures).
- AI awareness gap: 38 % among men vs. 23 % among women.
- In educational settings, the gap narrows significantly: 53 % male vs. 51 % female students use AI.

Education & Socio-Economic Factors

- University-educated individuals: **62 %** report understanding and using AI vs. **40 %** without a degree.
- College-educated daily workplace AI use rose from 22 % → 34 % in one year; non-college-educated use *declined* 6 points — a widening digital divide.
- EU youth (under 30): 44 % use AI for private purposes vs. 25 % of the general population.

7. Key Takeaways

1. **Milestone crossed:** Over 1.4 billion people — roughly 1 in 6 humans — actively use AI tools each month, yet 5 billion internet users have not yet adopted AI.
2. **South beats North:** Emerging markets (India, UAE, Chile) are adopting AI faster than developed economies, driven by mobile access and youthful demographics.
3. **ChatGPT dominates** with ~80 % chatbot market share and ~1 B monthly active users, growing from 300 M weekly actives to 900 M in under 12 months.
4. **Enterprise is all-in:** 78 % of organisations now use AI; 92 % of Fortune 500 companies use ChatGPT; 86 % plan to increase AI budgets.
5. **Economic magnitude:** The global AI market will reach \$800 B+ by 2030, with cumulative generative AI economic impact projected at \$19.9 trillion.
6. **Workforce transformation:** AI will create 170 M new jobs while displacing 92 M — a net positive — but reskilling and bridging the digital divide are critical imperatives.
7. **Demographic divide:** Gen Z leads adoption; a widening gender and education gap risks concentrating AI's benefits among the already privileged.

Selected Sources

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